



Lancaster University
Management School

Department of Accounting and Finance

AcF 100: Introduction to Accounting and Finance

Business Environment

Annotated Bibliography

This task must be carried out in your allocated ACF100 project group. Project groups will be allocated during **week 3**. If you join the course after the project groups are allocated, it is your responsibility to find out which group you have been allocated to by contacting the Student Support Assistant (Rowan Hall, r.hall6@lancaster.ac.uk).

1. The task

Each group is required to produce an annotated bibliography on a chosen issue from the list provided below in section 2. The aim of the annotated bibliography is **not** to provide comprehensive coverage or evaluation of a topic/issue but, as a group, to identify and clearly and concisely discuss useful and relevant source materials relating to the issue. The group is restricted to including **one source material per member**. It is important that the sources used should be presented to put forward a viewpoint on the issue that is supported by evidence from the source materials. Therefore, the group should consider carefully and agree upon which are the most appropriate source materials to include.

1.1. What is an annotated bibliography?

It is helpful to break the phrase 'annotated bibliography' down as follows:

- Bibliography => a list of sources
- Annotation => notes explaining something

Therefore:

An annotated bibliography is a collection of the sources you have used to research a particular topic, with brief explanations or notes which:

- Describe the sources' content.
- Summarises the main argument.
- And sometimes briefly analyses the source itself.

Please see [link to moodle](#) for further information about the purpose of an annotated bibliography along with some examples.

1.2. What should be included in the annotated bibliography?

The annotated bibliography has to include:

- a. A title page including the names of all team members.
- b. A brief introduction outlining the chosen issue (including any necessary background).
- c. Discussion of various source materials, one by one.
- d. A conclusion which summarises the main arguments in your readings.
- e. A reference list (which is the bibliography element).
- f. An appendix containing the group contribution sheet.

1.3. The requirement

Each group member should pick **one** source material item to write about and he/she will be responsible for writing the discussion piece (the 'annotations') on this particular item for this section

of the annotated bibliography. Each source material item should be discussed in a subsection of between a minimum of 100 and a maximum of 300 words (between one and three paragraphs). In this discussion you should address the following for each source material item:

- (i) topic coverage of the issue (i.e. what the source material item actually tells the reader about the topic area chosen or what aspects of the issue are addressed);
- (ii) the writer's viewpoint/argument/conclusions;
- (iii) how useful the piece is in terms of the information provided (i.e. how relevant is the piece and how much information is conveyed) and what evidence is put forward to support the writer's viewpoint; and
- (iv) how this extends or contradicts views put forward in source material items selected by other members of the group.

The group should include **at least one item of all** of the following source types in their overall portfolio of sources:

SOURCE TYPE 1: Academic journal article

SOURCE TYPE 2: Book or book extract or book chapter or report

SOURCE TYPE 3: High quality newspaper or magazine or periodical article

SOURCE TYPE 4: Webpage

Examples of these source types are included in section 9 of this document.

If there are more than four team members in the group, it is up to the group which source type is included twice (no source type should be referred to more than twice).

Each of the source materials should also be referenced fully in the reference list at the end of the annotated bibliography. The reference list should appear in alphabetical order by the author's surname (for sources that have more than one author, the first named author's surname determines the alphabetical order in the reference list). PLEASE NOTE: You should find new source materials for this task, i.e. materials included should not be contained in the course reading list.

1.4. Word limit

The length of your annotated bibliography will depend upon the number of members in your group. The introduction and concluding sections should **in total** be no more than **500 words long**. It is recommended that each is approximately 250 words.

The discussion for **each source material item** should be a **minimum of 100 words and a maximum of 300 words**. Please note: one source material item per group member is required and each member is responsible for his/her piece – groups will be penalised if any members do not select and comment on their selected item. In addition, although this is a group effort, it is important that the finished piece hangs together properly as a single document, and is consistent in style and format throughout. It is useful to make one person responsible for this task. See below suggestions for group organisation in section 4.

Please note: the Module Director is unable to provide feedback on the choice of sources and/or the annotated bibliography in advance of the coursework submission date.

1.5. Deadline

The deadline is **Wednesday 23rd November 2022 at 12 noon (UK time)**. **Please note: late mark penalties will be applied if your group's annotated bibliography is not submitted by this deadline.**

All submissions must also contain the contribution sheet as an Appendix (please download the template from Moodle). Please ensure the names of all team members are included in your annotated bibliography. **Only ONE copy per group is required for submission.** Therefore, please allocate someone in your team the task of uploading the PDF document on Moodle prior to the deadline.

Please note: The Department reserves the right to adjust coursework marks after coursework has been returned to students in order to ensure that the coursework marks have an appropriate distribution.

1.6. How and where to submit your assignment

Your annotated bibliography must be submitted online in a **PDF** file via the AcF100 Moodle site. The submission folder is contained within the 'Assessments and assessment guidance' section. Please note that the folder will not become visible to you until the end of week 6 to encourage you to work on this together over a three week period.

2. Topic areas

The group should choose **ONE** topic from the list below:

- a. The impact which technology has upon the accounting profession.

Note that accounting profession means accountants in the broadest sense so could include financial accountants, management accountants, tax experts, actuaries amongst others.

- b. The risks and opportunities for the accounting profession arising from global events for example Covid-19 or Brexit.

Note that Covid-19 or Brexit are purely examples and other global events are equally as relevant.

- c. The importance for an organisation's performance of having a diverse workforce (including diversity among senior executives).

- d. The main threats posed to the accounting profession from high-profile audit failures?

It is entirely up to the group which topic is chosen and the same marks are available for each of the topic areas. The marking criteria is detailed further in section 6 of this document.

3. Formatting of your annotated bibliography

Your annotated bibliography should be word-processed with 1.5 line spacing. An appropriate font size to use is Arial or Times New Roman size 12 (or similar) for the main body text. You may wish to enlarge the font size used for any headings/title of your piece. The sections/subsections should be clearly titled. You should also clearly label any charts, tables or diagrams (and identify the source of information) used in your annotated bibliography, if you decide to include any of these. To help the marker, you may also wish to leave a line between each paragraph and indent the start of each paragraph.

You should include a title page which includes the names and student ID numbers of team members. Ensure all pages are correctly numbered and include a word count at the end of the document.

Please note: The reference list is not included in the word count, but citations **within the text** are included in the word count (not headings). There is **no 10% allowance in the word count** and if you go over the word limit, it is at the marker's discretion as to whether you will be penalised for this.

A common mistake is to report on everything. This is **not** necessary or effective! It is important to focus on the key issues. Additional material should be placed in an appendix, but be selective in this. If you do decide to include material in an appendix, it is important to refer to this in the main text of your annotated bibliography (Note: the appendix is **not** usually included within the word count, but it should not be seen as a dumping ground for material exceeding the word limit.).

4. Group organisation

4.1. Groups

At the end of Week 3 you will be allocated to your group. An announcement will be released using ACF100 Moodle – please note your group will be formed of other members of your workshop, this will help you make friends within your workshop itself.

Once your groups are released I would strongly recommend immediately arranging when to meet up so you can start working on the task. There are plenty of places on campus and in the Management School where you could meet up. Whilst you can speak with your group mates in your workshop, I will also set up some groups on Microsoft Teams so you can also speak with each other on there if you choose. Things you will want to do in the first meeting include:

- Introducing yourself to your group mates.
- Discussing the task.
- Reviewing written versions of draft documents.
- Documenting minutes for each meeting.

4.2. Team roles

It is up to you how you decide to arrange the various team roles. It is recommended that you elect the following roles:

- Chair (someone who has an overview role for the whole project and ensures everything is completed by the deadline).
- Editor (someone who can review the annotated bibliography after the writing is complete for consistency and coherence, and make necessary suggestions to individual group members for stylistic changes to their individual contributions to ensure coherence, and ensures consistency with the introduction and conclusion)
- Secretary (someone to take team meeting minutes)

Your group is required to keep a record of progress throughout the term through meeting minutes. Guidance is provided below for arranging meetings and writing meeting minutes.

4.3. Arranging meetings & meeting minutes

4.3.1. Arranging meetings

In arranging a meeting, students should pay careful consideration to any of their team members who do not live on campus and ensure that they arrange a mutually convenient time to meet. What may be a convenient time for one member of the group may be very inconvenient for another.

At a minimum it is recommended that you have meetings as follows:

- Week 4 => introductions, allocating team roles and allocating sources.

- Week 5 => progress meeting and review any work completed to date.
- Week 6 => progress meeting. Note that at this stage you should almost have completed your individual elements.
- Week 7 => final review of the report and agreement for submission.

4.3.2. Sending apologies

It is the group's responsibility to arrange group meetings. Anyone who is going to be absent from a meeting should send their apologies to the group chair or secretary. Apologies should be sent using the chat in Teams. **It is expected that students will attend group meetings unless there are exceptional circumstances which prevent them from doing so.**

4.3.3. Writing an agenda

When arranging the meeting, an agenda of items for discussion should be agreed and circulated to all team members in advance. This gives people the chance to prepare for the meeting and should be used as the basis for discussion.

4.3.4. Meeting minutes

Each group should keep a record of the meeting minutes from each meeting. The minutes should contain the following:

- Time, date and venue of the meeting
- List of people attending
- List of people absent from the meeting
- Approval of previous minutes from meetings and any matters arising from the minutes
- For each item on the agenda, a record of the main points discussed and the conclusion of the discussion.
- Record any action points (i.e. work tasks) arising from the discussion and who is going to take responsibility for them.
- Time, date and venue of the next meeting
- Name of person taking the minutes

After the meeting the minutes should be written up and circulated to all team members.

Tip: Keep the minutes short and to the point. It is **not** necessary to have a word-for-word account of what was said, just a summary of the main points and any action points agreed. Write these as soon as you can after the meeting when they are fresh in your mind.

5. Monitoring contribution & resolving team difficulties

Employers often tell us that the reason they like Lancaster University graduates is their experience of undertaking group work during their university course. We believe that this is a very important skill for students to practise on the AcF 100 course. However, we acknowledge that on occasion there may be problems within a group and it is important in group work to ensure everyone is making their contribution.

5.1. Monitoring Contribution

To ensure that all students contribute equitably to the project, each group will be required to complete a project group contribution sheet listing the actual tasks and contribution made by each group member. It is therefore important that each group keeps a rough journal of its process and this will be assisted by the meeting minutes which the group should prepare after each meeting.

The chair should fill in the group contribution sheet **in consultation** with his/her project team. The form contains sections where the individual contribution towards the various tasks is highlighted. Where a person has **not** been contributing, this should also be highlighted. The contribution sheet should be agreed **by all team members**. An example of the contribution sheet is included at the end of this document. The contribution sheet will be available to download from Moodle.

Reviews of individual contributions towards the task will be carried out by the course director and tutor.

Please Note: If it emerges that individual team members have not made an equitable contribution, your tutor in conjunction with the course director have the power to take action against non-contributing members, including reducing their individual marks. **We will only use evidence through meeting minutes and the group contribution sheet so it is vital that groups record the discussions and outcomes.**

5.2. Resolving Team Difficulties

If the group is experiencing problems during the term, you should first meet up and try and resolve the issues **within the group** in the first instance. If this is not possible, then the team (or an individual team member) should contact the course contact (Andrew) during his advertised office hours to discuss the issue. However you must be able to demonstrate that you have attempted to resolve the issue.

Also note, that group mates should **not** make unilateral decisions to exclude an individual team member from the group. This can often cause as many difficulties as a group member not engaging with the task.

6. Marking criteria

The mark awarded for the annotated bibliography will be out of 100 (i.e. a percentage mark). Marks will be awarded primarily for the evaluation of sources, linkage between different parts of the annotated bibliography, structuring of the annotated bibliography and the quality of the writing. There will also be marks available for the appropriateness of referencing and presentation of the document. The following marking criteria will be used in assessing the annotated bibliography:

Degree Classification	Description	Mark (%)
CLASS I	(a) Accurate and complete, demonstrating good understanding of the content of source materials in depth. Well ordered, using good English, appropriate sources chosen and includes introduction and concluding sections. Use of citations in the text and complete references section in Harvard style. Some presentation of materials to put forward a viewpoint on an issue.	70-79%
	(b) In addition, excellent linkage between the sources and logical flow of ideas in piece to present viewpoint.	80-89%
	(c) In addition, original perspectives or insights into the chosen sources, argued logically.	90-100%
CLASS Iii	(d) Comprehensive discussion of sources, with some linkages between sources. Showing understanding based on an ability to extract relevant information and to support viewpoint with choice of appropriate sources. Good English. Includes introduction and concluding sections. Good citations and references section.	65-69%
	(e) As (d) but either occasionally lacking accuracy or with too much focus on some source materials over other sources; inadequate discussion of one of the chosen source materials.	60-64%
CLASS Iiii	(f) Concise but accurate. Based largely on repeating the source materials content, rather than presenting a viewpoint. Too much reliance upon quotations for certain source materials. Information presented clearly but lacking any originality or thought in how to present the materials to show support for a viewpoint.	55-59%
	(g) As (f) but with weak linkages between the sources and poor discussion. Poor choice of source materials.	50-54%

Degree Classification	Description	Mark (%)
CLASS III	(h) Answer merely repeats the material detailed in the source, with lapses in accuracy and logic in discussion. Sources chosen not very relevant to the topic area selected and are not put forward to present a clear viewpoint. Some evidence of knowledge and understanding of referencing, but the sources are not properly acknowledged.	45-49%
	(i) As (h) but with serious omissions. Limited discussion of the source materials. Presentation/referencing poor. Sources chosen are inadequate and are presented independently in the report, rather than to support a view point.	40-44%
FAIL	(j) Omission of some required source materials and poor discussion, though some discussion relevant to the question. Evidence that the question has been understood in part at least. Poor writing/ structuring, presentation/referencing poor.	35-39%
	(k) Inadequate choice of sources with little relevance to the topic areas presented. No introduction or concluding sections. Writing style/presentation/referencing is poor.	30-34%
	(l) Sources not relevant to topic area and poor discussion. Extremely poor referencing/plagiarism.	20-29%
	(m) Little hint of any knowledge from source materials to present an argument on the selected topic area. May be an answer to the "wrong" question.	10-19%
	(n) No source types relevant to the question but the group has made some effort. Report poorly written and referenced.	1-9%

7. Feedback

Feedback is important as it helps you learn what you did well and where you need to seek help or to improve for the future. Feedback on AcF100 course tasks takes a number of forms, dependent upon the task. We plan to provide feedback on this task to your group during week 11 (Lent Term). For this task, feedback will be provided electronically via Moodle and the system will notify you when your group's feedback is available to review online. Also some marker notes on overall feedback will be provided on Moodle for you to review and there will also be an overall feedback session in week 10 Michaelmas term.

8. Guidance on referencing

A reference list should be provided at the end of your annotated bibliography, which refers only to those sources, books, articles and website addresses you have actually used in writing your annotated bibliography. The reference list is **not included** in the word count. The Department of Accounting and Finance has adopted the **Harvard** system of referencing.

For examples of how to reference you should refer to the LUMS referencing guide and the library guide at [the following link](#).

There is also a referencing guide on the [LUMS Learning Development Learning Moodle Page](#) (You will need to self-enrol to access this resource).

It should be noted that referencing is normally the biggest issue with submissions of the annotated bibliography task. Students often make simple errors which can easily be avoided by checking each reference to the referencing guide. We don't expect you to remember how to reference. However we do expect that you will be able to find the guide and use it effectively.

9. Recognising different source types

Below is a list of resources by source type which the team may find useful. This is *not meant to be comprehensive*; it is merely to provide you with an indicator of the type of acceptable resources to use. It is especially important that you understand the difference between an academic journal article and a periodical article.

9.1. List of academic journal titles:

- Academy of Management Journal
- Accounting and Business Research
- Accounting, Auditing and Accountability Journal
- Accounting Horizons
- Accounting, Organizations and Society
- British Accounting Review
- British Journal of Management
- Contemporary Accounting Research
- Corporate Governance: An International Review
- Critical Perspectives on Accounting
- European Accounting Review
- European Management Journal
- Human Relations
- Human Resource Management Journal
- Information and Management
- Information Technology and People
- Journal of Accounting and Economics
- Journal of Accounting Research
- Journal of Management Information Systems
- Journal of Political Economy
- The Accounting Review
- The Quarterly Journal of Economics

You may find [Google Scholar](#) helpful in identifying relevant journal articles. Electronic access to journals from the [library website](#) is via OneSearch.

9.2. List of Newspapers:

Please note: If you access the newspaper via Nexis, the page number of the article is provided. If you instead access the newspaper by another electronic method, the page number may not always be provided. If this is the case, please ensure you include the author, date and title of article, name of newspaper, relevant weblink and the date you downloaded the piece in the full reference.

- The Daily Telegraph
- The Financial Times
- The Guardian
- The Times

Access to newspapers is from the Lancaster University Website of [databases](#).

9.3. List of Magazines/Periodicals:

These are all treated as journals by the library search system, so to find articles you need to search via the library OneSearch system.

- Accountancy Daily
- Harvard Business Review
- The Economist

9.4. Books:

Check the University library catalogue for useful texts.

9.5. Webpages:

Try and find unique webpage resources, rather than using the electronic copy of newspaper or journal article sources. You may include blogs or videos here in your searches – search via [Google](#).

9.6. Other Sources of Advice:

You may also find these websites from the University library useful to help the group in the search for relevant sources:

- [Searching the Literature](#).
- Videos on [Using Lancaster University Library OneSearch](#).
- [Critical Appraisal. Evaluating books, journals and websites](#).
- On-line course “[Introduction to referencing and reference management tools](#)” (Guides you through referencing and Refworks and Endnote softwares although it is recommended you complete the referencing yourself so you learn how to reference properly).

10. SELF-HELP CHECKLIST

This section should be reviewed by the group prior to the submission of the annotated bibliography. This section provides guidance on: (i) document formatting, (ii) document structure and argumentation, (iii) writing style, appropriateness and accuracy of language, and (iv) referencing conventions. Active web-links are available below to additional study skills resources that may help the group in preparing/checking their annotated bibliography prior to submission.

10.1. Format

- Does the cover sheet have all necessary information included? Is the exact title of the question included?
- Are the font and spacing clear and legible?
- Does it follow the specifications for word count/number of pages?

10.2. Structure and argumentation

- Is there a helpful introduction?
- Is effective reasoning used? (Do you support points with explanations, illustrations, justifications, evidence?)
- Are headings/subheadings helpful and sufficient?
- Are the points in logical order?
- Does the paragraphing help the reader understand the argument and flow of ideas?
- [Is there one topic per paragraph?](#) (there should be no one-sentence paragraphs)
- Are there clear breaks between paragraphs to show where they start and end?
- [Is it clear how the ideas link together?](#) (both within and between paragraphs)

10.3. Style, appropriateness and accuracy of language

- [Is a formal style used](#), including full paragraphs (not notes or bullet points)?
- Is it clear and easy to follow (not too cryptic or overcomplicated)?
- [Is English grammar used accurately](#) e.g. tenses, word endings etc.
- [Is the punctuation clear and accurate e.g. full stops, commas, semi-colons?](#)
- Is the spelling accurate?
- Have the spelling and grammar tools from Microsoft Word been used to double-check?

10.4. Referencing conventions:

- Are citations given in the text for all the source material used? See [LUMS Reference Guide](#) (self-enrol on Moodle to access resource).
- Are direct quotations given in quotation marks with surname, date and page number where available? Are paraphrases and quotations used appropriately (e.g. not too much quotation)?
- Are sources which the student has read for her/himself acknowledged clearly with surname and date of the source?
- Are indirect sources - ones the students has not read him/herself but has seen mentioned by

other writers - acknowledged properly, giving the **original** source? E.g. *(Kim and Lim 2003 cited in Brown 2004)*.

- Are websites cited in the text concisely (i.e. author/organisation and date only)?
- Are **all** the sources acknowledged within the text **also** included in the reference list at the end?
- Are the references in alphabetical order of surname (of first named author for references with multiple authors), with the surname first followed by the initial(s)? For books, are **all** the details included? (author, year, title, place of publication and publisher.)
- For journal articles, are **all** the details included? (author(s), year, title of article, journal name, volume/issue number, page range.)
- Are journal titles and book titles given in italics?
- For electronic sources, are **all** the details included? (author/organisation, date, full URL and date accessed)

APPENDIX A: GROUP CONTRIBUTION SHEET

The contribution sheet must be completed by the chair and included in the electronic submission to Moodle. This document may be downloaded from the AcF100 Moodle site.



DEPARTMENT OF ACCOUNTING AND FINANCE

AcF100: Group Contribution Sheet

Michaelmas Term 2022

Group Number: _____

Group Chairperson: _____

Workshop day & Time: _____

Tutor: _____

Name	Task(s) responsible for/Section of annotated bibliography written:
1.	
2.	
3.	
4.	
5.	
6.	

ANY OTHER COMMENTS: